Transportation Solutions Operating Benchmark

SUBVERTICAL LENS

Four models require separate estimates: railcar leasing, locomotive leasing, airport GSE leasing and outsourced yard logistics. Asset lessors earn higher margins with heavier reinvestment; yard logistics is labor-led, lower-margin and much lighter-capital.

METRIC	ESTIMATE	ASSERTION	CONFIDENCE
Revenue growth	Railcar **4%**; Loco **6%**; GSE **8%**; Yard **7%**	Railcar growth is held to 4% because mature fleets depend mainly on rate, utilization and measured additions; locomotives receive 6% for modernization demand. GSE and yard services receive 8% and 7% for outsourcing, electrification and new-site wins.	MEDIUM
EBITDA margin	Railcar **58%**; Loco **62%**; GSE **30%**; Yard **14%**	Railcar and locomotive estimates remain high because lease revenue sits on long-lived assets; the 62% locomotive estimate is normalized below Akiem's roughly 68% result. GSE carries workshop costs, while yard services are labor-led.	MEDIUM
Maintenance capex / revenue	Railcar **18%**; Loco **18%**; GSE **14%**; Yard **4%**	Railcar and locomotive estimates reflect overhaul, replacement, compliance and ERTMS work; GSE's 14% reflects refurbishment, batteries and workshop support. Yard services require only tractors and technology at 4%.	MEDIUM
Customer tenor INITIAL / EFFECTIVE	Railcar **4 / 9 yrs**; Loco **7 / 12 yrs**; GSE **5 / 9 yrs**; Yard **3 / 7 yrs**	Initial terms lengthen with asset value, approval burden and mobilization complexity, making locomotives longest and yard contracts shortest. Effective tenure is longer because fleets, airport packages and embedded yard operations are commonly renewed or refreshed.	MEDIUM
Utilization exposure	Railcar **Moderate**; Loco **Moderate**; GSE **Moderate-High**; Yard **High**	Rail exposure is Moderate because leased deployment matters but assets can be redeployed across long economic lives. GSE adds station activity and spare-fleet risk, while yard services are High because contribution depends on productive labor hours.	MEDIUM-HIGH
New-unit / customer payback	Railcar **9 yrs**; Loco **10 yrs**; GSE **5.5 yrs**; Yard **1.5 yrs**	Rail assets receive nine-to-ten-year paybacks because high upfront cost must be recovered over multiple placements and residual value matters. GSE is cheaper but service-heavy at 5.5 years, while yard launch spend can recover in about 1.5 years.	MEDIUM
B2B vs B2C	All models **Predominantly B2B**	All four models are predominantly B2B because contractual buyers are rail operators, public authorities, airports, ground handlers, industrial firms and logistics providers. The benchmarked operations have no meaningful direct consumer revenue.	HIGH

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BUSINESS UNIVERSE

Five businesses map to four models: railcar, locomotive, airport GSE and yard logistics. The economic unit shifts from an earning asset, to a station fleet package, to a site contract and productive service hour.

VTG

Evidence. 2024: EUR405m operating cash flow and EUR536m fixed-asset investment, mainly new wagons and maintenance; tank utilization stayed high while intermodal softened.
Business. Leases and manages European freight wagons for industrial shippers and rail operators.
Economics. Unit: earning wagon; revenue: recurring lease plus services. Customers avoid capital and secure compliant, cargo-specific capacity. VTG maintains and redeploys fleets; integration retains customers, while lane loss and intermodal weakness create churn.

Akiem

Evidence. 2021: 600+ locomotives, 46 passenger trains, about EUR220m revenue and EUR150m EBITDA.
Business. Leases and maintains locomotives and some passenger rolling stock across Europe.
Economics. Unit: locomotive under lease/full service. Operators outsource scarce, compliant traction. Akiem runs workshops, overhauls and upgrades; approvals and uptime support retention, while concession loss or technical mismatch cause churn.

Air Rail

Evidence. IFM owns 75%. March 2026: 4,700+ units, about 60 airports, eight countries and 68% of motorized units electric.
Business. AIR RAIL, S.L. leases, maintains and refurbishes airport GSE; it also has rail activities.
Economics. Unit: deployed GSE/station package. Rental, maintenance, parts and resale solve airline/handler capex and uptime needs. Airport service embeds relationships; rebids and transfer friction cause churn. Fleets, batteries and charging drive capital needs.

TCR

Evidence. 44,000+ assets, 100+ workshops, 1,800+ employees, 24 countries and 200+ airports.
Business. Rents, maintains, refurbishes and electrifies GSE for airlines, handlers and airports.
Economics. Unit: GSE/airport fleet package. Full-service rent and lifecycle services solve turnaround uptime and capital needs. Workshops, technicians and spares embed TCR; handler rebids drive churn. Scale aids utilization but requires renewal and reserve fleet.

Lazer Logistics

Evidence. EQT reports 550+ sites, 5,000 employees, 6,000 fleet assets and 9m annual service hours.
Business. Runs warehouse and industrial yards using drivers, equipment, processes and technology.
Economics. Unit: site contract/service hour. Recurring site and labor revenue solves trailer-flow bottlenecks. Lazer staffs and supervises yards; integration supports retention, while rebids, closures and volume loss cause churn. Labor utilization dominates limited equipment capital.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

1. Keep the four archetypes separate; asset ownership and labor intensity drive the economics.
2. Obtain gross replacement, refurbishment, electrification and growth-fleet capex splits.
3. Measure paid utilization, off-lease days and redeployment cost by asset family.